Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) None of the above is a correct inference

Ans. (a) According to the passage, the correct conclusion is that due to deforestation, the course of rivers can be changed. The drying up of inland springs and relatively small rivers in the Himalayan region can be attributed to drastic charges in forest cover. An indirect consequence is drastic charge in the highland lowland interactions through water, which is the reason for the diversion of rivers.

11. With reference to 'desertification', as described in the passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. Desertification is a phenomenon in tropical areas only.
2. Deforestation invariably leads to floods and desertification.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b) Assumption (1) is invalid with reference to the line, 'While this phenomenon…….dramatic "which indicates that the phenomenon is not limited to the tropical areas.
Assumption (2) is valid as the passage mentions "desertification and inundation" as the effects of deforestation.

Passage – 2

A diversity of natural assets will be needed to cope with climate change and ensure productive agriculture, forestry, and fisheries. For example, crop varieties are needed that perform well under drought, heat, and enhanced CO_2. But the private-sector and farmer-led process of choosing crops favours homogeneity adapted to past or current conditions, not varieties capable of producing consistently high yields in warmer, wetter, or drier conditions. Accelerated breeding programmes are needed to conserve a wider pool of genetic resources of existing crops, breeds, and their wild relatives. Relatively intact ecosystems, such as forested catchments, mangroves, wetlands, can buffer the impacts of climate change. Under a changing climate, these ecosystems are themselves at risk, and management approaches will need to be more proactive and adaptive. Connections between natural areas, such as migration corridors, may be needed to facilitate species movements to keep up with the change in climate.

12. With reference to the above passage, which of the following would assist us in coping with the climate change?

1. Conservation of natural water sources
2. Conservation of wider gene pool
3. Existing crop management practices
4. Migration corridors

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (b) Statement (1), (2) and (4) are correct in the context of the above passage in that conservation of natural water resources, conservation of a wider gene pool and migration corridors would be helpful in combating climate change as well as linkages between natural areas such as migration corridors. The need will be to facilitate the mobility of species so as to cope with climate change.

13. With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. Diversification of livelihoods acts as a coping strategy for climate change.
2. Adoption of monocropping practice leads to the extinction of plant varieties and their wild relatives.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) The assumption which can be made as per the passage are diversification of livelihood helps to combat climate change strategy and adoption of monocropping practices leads to soil erosion and reduce micro organism habitats. Thus both the assumption are valid.

Passage – 3

Today the top environmental challenge is a combination of people and their aspirations. If the aspirations are more like the frugal ones we had after the Second World War, a lot more is possible than if we view the planet as a giant shopping mall. We need to get beyond the fascination with glitter and understand that the planet works as a biological system.

14. Which of the following is the most crucial and logical inference that can be made from the above passage?

(a) The Earth can meet only the basic needs of humans for food, clothing and shelter.
(b) The only way to meet environmental challenge is to limit human population.
(c) Reducing our consumerism is very much in our own interest.
(d) Knowledge of biological systems can only help us save this planet.

Ans. (c) The most conclusive and logical conclusion from the above passage is "it is in our own interest to reduce consumerism, so option (c) is correct. According to the author, today the consumerist is making improper use of organic elements to fulfill his selfish interests.

Passage – 4

Some people believe that leadership is a quality which you have at birth or not at all. This theory is false, for the art of leadership can be acquired and can indeed be taught. This discovery is made in time of war and the results achieved can surprise even the instructors. Faced with the alternatives of going left or right, every soldier soon grasps that a prompt decision either way is better than an endless discussion. A firm choice of direction has an even chance of being right while to do nothing will be almost certainly wrong.

15. The author of the passage holds the view that

(a) leadership can be taught through war experience only
(b) leadership can be acquired as well as taught
(c) the results of training show that more people acquire leadership than are expected
(d) despite rigorous instruction, very few leaders are produced

Ans. (b) The author of the above passage is of the opinion that leadership can be acquired as well as taught. In the above passage, the author has given the example of soldiers taking quick decisions, in which according to the author, if they make a firm choice of any direction, the there can be a chance of being right in it even when doing nothing is almost certainly wrong.

Directions for the following 8 (eight) items :
Read the following eight passages and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage - 1

All actions to address climate change ultimately involve costs. Funding is vital in order for countries like India to design and implement adaptation and mitigation plans and projects. The problem is more severe for developing countries like India, which would be one of the hardest hit by climate change, given its need to finance development. Most countries do indeed treat climate change as real threat and are striving to address it in a more comprehensive and integrated manner with the limited resources at their disposal.

16. With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. Climate change is not a challenge for developed countries.
2. Climate change is a complex policy issue and also a development issue for many countries.
3. Ways and means of finance must be found to enable developing countries to enhance their adaptive capacity.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) According to the author in the passage. climate change is a complex policy issue, also development issue for many countries developing countries should be enable to enhance their climate adoptive capacity.

Passage-2

Cooking with biomass and coal in India is now recognised to cause major health problems, with women and children in poor populations facing the greatest risk. There are more than 10 lakh premature deaths each year from household air pollution due polluting cooking fuels with another 1.5 lakh due to their contribution to general outdoor air pollution in the country. Although the fraction of the Indian population using clean cooking fuels, such as LPG, natural gas and electricity, is slowly rising, the number using polluting solid fuels as their primary cooking fuel has remained static for nearly 30 years at about 70 crore.

17. Which of the following is the most crucial and logical inference that can be made from the passage?

(a) Rural people are giving up the use of polluting solid fuels due to their increasing awareness of health hazards.
(b) Subsidizing the use of clean cooking fuels will solve the problem of India's indoor air pollution.
(c) India should increase its import of natural gas and produce more electricity.
(d) Access to cooking gas can reduce premature deaths in poor households.

Ans. (d) Option (d) is the most conclusive and logical conclusion that can be drawn from the above passage, according to which premature deaths can be reduced in poor households by providing them access to cooking gas, because every year more than 10 lakh asymptomatic cases are reported in these households. Deaths occur due to domestic air pollution, which is caused by polluting fuels used in cooking, and upto 1.5 lakh deaths occur due to outdoor air pollution in the country due to such fuels.

Passage- 3

Scientific knowledge has its dangers, but so has every great thing. Over and beyond the dangers with which if threatens the present, it opens up as nothing else can, the vision of a possible happy world; a world without poverty, without war, with little illness. Science, whatever unpleasant consequences it may have by the way, is in its very nature a liberator.

18. Which one of the following is the most important implication of the passage?

(a) A happy world is a dream of science.
(b) Science only can build a happy world, but it is also the only major threat.
(c) A happy world is not possible without science.
(d) A happy world is not at all possible with or without science.

Ans. (a) The most important implication of the above passage is option (a), science has the potential to uplift the state of living of mankind so that a happy world is a dream of science.